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Institutional Briefing Series

Portfolio-controlled strategy, doctrine, intelligence, and operating papers

FOLIO · RESOURCES/STRATEGIC-FRAMEWORKS/V4

Strategic Frameworks v4

A complete operating system for strategic decisions — built for boards, founders, and institutional builders.

CONTROL METADATA

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Verification



Strategic Frameworks v4

This is the **operational spine**: a decision architecture designed to survive real constraints — pressure, ambiguity, conflicting incentives, and limited time.

If your strategy cannot withstand:

- scrutiny,
- risk,
- accountability,
- and execution friction,

then it is not strategy. It is theatre.

1) Executive Summary (60 seconds)

What it is

A set of integrated frameworks that convert uncertainty into **governable decisions** and convert decisions into **auditable execution**.

When to use

- Annual planning and resource allocation
- Pivot, restructure, or market expansion decisions
- Hiring or capability build vs. outsourcing
- Crisis response and reputational risk containment
- Governance redesign (authority, cadence, escalation)

What it produces

- a decision that can be defended,
- an execution plan that can be audited,
- and a cadence that prevents drift.

2) Decision Rights (Board Standard)

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Every strategic decision must have an explicit authority model.

DACI (recommended)

- ****D — Driver:**** responsible for progress and documentation
- ****A — Approver:**** final decision authority
- ****C — Contributors:**** provide analysis and constraints
- ****I — Informed:**** must be told, not consulted

Minimum decision record

- Decision statement (one sentence)
- Owner (Approver)
- Date decided
- Why now (trigger)
- Rationale (evidence)
- Risks + mitigations
- Next actions + deadlines

****Artifact:****

' ****[Board Decision Log Template]/(downloads/board-decision-log-template)****

3) Framework A — Purpose Pyramid (Mandate Alignment)

Use

Prevent strategic drift by aligning decisions to mandate maturity.

Levels

1. Survival (viability, legitimacy, cashflow)
2. Success (competitive advantage, excellence)
3. Significance (value beyond profit)
4. Legacy (institutions that outlast personalities)

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Operating rule

Do not speak like Legacy while performing like Survival.

****Board prompt****

- What level are we actually operating at today?
- What level must we reach in 12–24 months?
- What must stop for that transition to occur?

4) Framework B — The Decision Matrix (Impact x Risk x Reversibility)

Use

Prioritise and decide under constraint.

Scoring model (1–5 each)

- Impact (value created)
- Risk (downside magnitude)
- Reversibility (how costly to undo)
- Time-to-Value (speed of benefit)
- Capacity Fit (do we have the capability?)

Interpretation

- High impact + low reversibility = slow down, raise evidence bar
- Low impact + high risk = kill it
- High impact + high risk = contain risk before execution

5) Framework C — Risk Discipline (Containment before Growth)

Use

Ensure strategic moves do not create irreversible exposure.

The 5 risk classes

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- Financial (cashflow, runway, liquidity)
- Operational (process, delivery, quality failure)
- Legal/Compliance (regulatory, contracts)
- Reputational (trust, narrative exposure)
- Strategic (positioning, lock-in, opportunity cost)

Required output

A risk delta note:

- what risk increases,
- what risk decreases,
- and what mitigation is mandatory.

6) Framework D — Governance Ladder (Authority + Escalation)

Use

Stop silent failure by defining escalation rules.

Ladder design

- Level 1: team decision (bounded authority)
- Level 2: leadership decision (cross-functional)
- Level 3: board decision (material risk / irreversible)
- Level 4: emergency protocol (time-critical containment)

Board prompt

- What decisions are being escalated too late?
- What decisions are being escalated too early (wasting senior time)?

7) Framework E — Execution Cadence (Make strategy real)

Strategy is proven by rhythm.

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Cadence components

- Weekly: priorities + blockers (30 minutes)
- Monthly: decision review + risk register (60 minutes)
- Quarterly: strategy audit + resource allocation (half-day)
- Annual: mandate reset + capital deployment (1 day)

Artifact:

'**[Operating Cadence Pack](/downloads/operating-cadence-pack)**'

8) Worked Example (Board-Level)

Scenario

A founder-led institution is choosing between:

- 1) Expand to Market B
- 2) Double down on Market A
- 3) Build a partner channel

Inputs

- Constraint: 9 months runway
- Compliance risk in Market B
- Team is stretched; delivery quality unstable

Application

- Purpose Pyramid: currently Survival ' must reach Success
- Decision Matrix:
- Market B: high impact, high risk, low reversibility ' postpone until compliance mitigation exists
- Market A: medium impact, low risk, high reversibility ' proceed
- Partner channel: high impact, medium risk, medium reversibility ' pilot with strict guardrails

Output

Approver: Founder/Board chair

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-
- Decision: Double down on Market A + pilot partner channel
- Risk mitigation: partner contracts + delivery QA gates
- Cadence: weekly execution review + monthly decision log audit

9) Failure Modes (What destroys strategy)

- No owner (decisions float)
- No record (decisions cannot be defended)
- Too many priorities (execution collapses)
- No cadence (drift becomes normal)
- Risk treated as pessimism (until it becomes catastrophe)

10) Implementation: 14-Day Deployment Plan

Days 1–2 — Setup

- Assign DACI roles
- Adopt decision record standard
- Create a single “Decision Register”

Days 3–7 — First decisions

- Run 2 decisions through the Decision Matrix
- Produce 2 decision memos
- Add risk delta notes

Days 8–14 — Cadence

- Install weekly + monthly cadence
- Review the first two decisions for quality
- Adjust scoring weights to match your reality

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Attachments (deploy now)

- **[Board Decision Log Template](/downloads/board-decision-log-template)**
- **[Operating Cadence Pack](/downloads/operating-cadence-pack)**
- **[Canon Council Table Agenda](/resources/canon-council-table-agenda)**

Final word

Good strategy is not novelty.

It is **timeless truth applied with precision** — then audited until it becomes culture.

Back to index: **[Strategic Frameworks](/resources/strategic-frameworks)**

ATTESTATION

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